ENGLISH B2 · ANSWER KEY

Gradable and non-gradable adjectives

Solutions and feedback for the Gradable and non-gradable adjectives in English B2 exercise workbook.

THIS DOCUMENT

Answer key

Model answers and concise grammar explanations for every stage in the separate exercise workbook.

RECOMMENDED USE

Keep the three-document system together

Correct one stage at a time. Explain the rule aloud before marking an answer as secure.

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STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Recognition in context

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

A1

The initial estimate was slightly inaccurate.

Gradable quality is the best match because a quality placed at a point on a scale.

A2

The final performance was absolutely outstanding.

Extreme quality is the best match because an already intensified adjective presented categorically.

A3

The archive is virtually empty.

Absolute state is the best match because an absolute category modified for completeness or approximation.

A4

a quality placed at a point on a scale

The Gradable quality pattern communicates a quality placed at a point on a scale.

A5

an already intensified adjective presented categorically

The Extreme quality pattern communicates an already intensified adjective presented categorically.

A6

an absolute category modified for completeness or approximation

The Absolute state pattern communicates an absolute category modified for completeness or approximation.

Form and function

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

B1

Gradable quality / a quality placed at a point on a scale

The structure belongs to the Gradable quality pattern. Its communicative purpose is a quality placed at a point on a scale.

B2

Extreme quality / an already intensified adjective presented categorically

The structure belongs to the Extreme quality pattern. Its communicative purpose is an already intensified adjective presented categorically.

B3

Absolute state / an absolute category modified for completeness or approximation

The structure belongs to the Absolute state pattern. Its communicative purpose is an absolute category modified for completeness or approximation.

Guided discourse choices

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

C1

The initial estimate was slightly inaccurate.

Gradable quality: very/fairly/slightly + gradable adjective.

C2

The final performance was absolutely outstanding.

Extreme quality: absolutely/really + extreme adjective.

C3

The archive is virtually empty.

Absolute state: completely/virtually + absolute adjective.

C4

The initial estimate was slightly inaccurate.

Gradable quality: very/fairly/slightly + gradable adjective.

C5

The final performance was absolutely outstanding.

Extreme quality: absolutely/really + extreme adjective.

C6

The archive is virtually empty.

Absolute state: completely/virtually + absolute adjective.

Open reconstruction

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

D1

slightly inaccurate

Gradable quality requires “slightly inaccurate” in this model. very/fairly/slightly + gradable adjective.

D2

absolutely outstanding

Extreme quality requires “absolutely outstanding” in this model. absolutely/really + extreme adjective.

D3

virtually empty

Absolute state requires “virtually empty” in this model. completely/virtually + absolute adjective.

D4

very/fairly/slightly + gradable adjective

Gradable quality is built as very/fairly/slightly + gradable adjective.

D5

absolutely/really + extreme adjective

Extreme quality is built as absolutely/really + extreme adjective.

Controlled transformation

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

E1

The initial estimate was slightly inaccurate.

very/fairly/slightly + gradable adjective. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended gradable quality effect.

E2

The final performance was absolutely outstanding.

absolutely/really + extreme adjective. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended extreme quality effect.

E3

The archive is virtually empty.

completely/virtually + absolute adjective. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended absolute state effect.

E4

The initial estimate was slightly inaccurate.

very/fairly/slightly + gradable adjective. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended gradable quality effect.

Communicative production

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

F1

The initial estimate was slightly inaccurate. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses very/fairly/slightly + gradable adjective accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F2

The final performance was absolutely outstanding. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses absolutely/really + extreme adjective accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F3

The archive is virtually empty. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses completely/virtually + absolute adjective accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

07 · FEEDBACK

Diagnose the pattern, not only the score

Use this page to decide what to revisit in the complete guide.

CHECK · TRIGGER OR CONTEXT

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · AUXILIARY OR STRUCTURAL CHOICE

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MAIN VERB OR CLAUSE FORM

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MEANING AND REGISTER

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

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RETRIEVAL

Final self-check

Complete these prompts without reopening the guide.